

This past weekend Kim and I spent the weekend away in Idyllwild. One of the main goals of the trip was to take a hike together in the local San Jacinto mountains and Saturday morning we set off for Taquitz and Red Taquitz peaks.

Kim allowed me to plan the route and it ended up I somewhat inadvertently selected the harder of the trails up to our particular summit. Kim was nice enough not to pitch me over the nearest drop for this.



We climbed up the South Ridge Trail stopping periodically to play on (and under) various rocks.



The initial climb up to Taquitz Peak was about 4 miles uphill. We were lucky for this part because the sun was mostly hidden behind clouds. We didn't run into a single person until we made it to the peak and the ones we met there had come up other somewhat less strenuous route.



By the time we made the summit it had gotten a bit warm. After a short rest we decided to push on to the second more wilderness-y summit, Red Taquitz.





We gave up a little of our altitude to meet up with the Pacific Crest Trail.



Eventually we found an unmarked use trail leading up in what we hoped was the right direction.



A short climb later we came to the peak. Unlike Taquitz this one was completely deserted. After crawling around for a bit I found the peak log and we added our signatures.





I had been eyeing a dangerous looking outcropping a small distance from the summit. With Kim's somewhat less than enthusiastic blessings I took off across a rather narrow ridge with instructions to please take a picture if I manage to plummet off the side. Sadly the pictures don't quite capture how sudden the drops were on all sides but it was quite a view while I was perched up there.



The hike back was hot and seemed a bit long. We saw a coyote on the trail ahead of us at one point but he ran off before we got close enough to get a decent picture (next time we need to bring a poodle for bait.) By the time we made it back to the car we were a bit low on water and a feeling on the warm side but still managed to be smiling.





And finally, the cabin we graciously allowed to stay at.

Assorted other images from the hike:

<http://www.flickr.com/photos/14698974@N00/sets/72157600854713202/>

Next weekend is a three peak hike, all of which are above 10K!